# Taehun Kim

**Staff Data Scientist** 10 years in data science

Coupang Fintech / Pay | May 2022 - present

I build AI products for financial services, combining hands-on modeling with product decisions, risk trade-offs, and business evaluation. At Coupang, I lead work across lending, fraud prevention, and GenAI tools - from defining the problem to launch, adoption, and ongoing improvement.

> My focus: deciding what is worth building, developing the solution, and making it useful in day-to-day decisions.

## PREVIOUS EXPERIENCE

**Kimberly-Clark** | Senior Data Scientist

D2C prediction and recommendation models; global marketing data standardization.

**IBM** | Data Scientist

Automotive-parts forecasting POC with data scientists in the UK, Germany, and Japan.

**Hana Institute of Technology** | Data Scientist

Small-business credit scoring, robo-advisory, and marketing automation.

AI and data research arm of Hana Financial Group, one of Korea's four major financial groups.

## TEACHING, WRITING & RECOGNITION

**Adjunct Professor | Ajou University**

Mar 2025 - present

Graduate AI program - Understanding Financial AI / AI System Design

Joint 14th in South Korea / THE World University Rankings 2027

**Author | Financial AI in Practice** | Manning

**Kaggle Notebooks Grandmaster**

## COMPANY REFERENCE

### Coupang

A NYSE-listed technology company spanning e-commerce, food delivery, streaming, and fintech.

#132

2026 Fortune 500

U.S. companies by revenue

24.7M

Product Commerce active customers

Q2 2026

**Leadership principles**

Wow the Customer

Ruthless Prioritization

Dive Deep

Influence without Authority

All 15 leadership principles | About Coupang

## EDUCATION

**UC San Diego**

Master's degree / International Economics

**Peking University**

Bachelor's degree / International Relations

## LANGUAGES

Korean / Mandarin Chinese / English

# From business problems to working products.

| CATEGORY | PROJECT | BUSINESS OBJECTIVE | MODELING / ARCHITECTURE | MY OWNERSHIP | BUSINESS IMPACT / EVALUATION |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Operations | **AI analytics platform**<br>Ongoing | Enable self-service analytics; free BA capacity. | Text-to-SQL; graph-structured SQL / DAG knowledge; RAG, MCP, vLLM. | Prioritized use cases; led development, rollout, training, and feedback. | **~70% fewer ad hoc BA tickets;** continuous iteration. Target: >=80% task completion within 3 turns. |
| Lending | **MCA: launch risk framework** | Launch seller lending without repayment history. | Stop-selling proxies; sales-based repayment simulation; shared seller feature layer. | Defined proxy labels and risk tiers; shaped lending decisions with policy teams. | Enabled cold-start launch with expected loss within the agreed target range. |
| Lending | **MCA: forecasts & early risk** | Maximize risk-adjusted profitability within risk appetite. | Transformer sales forecasts, P10/P50/P90; early-risk and seller-collapse models. | Shaped limit policies using forecast quantiles, risk signals, and seller tiers. | **Estimated ~10% increase in risk-adjusted margin (RAM)** within the agreed risk appetite. |
| Lending | **BNPL scoring** | Control delinquency using platform behavior. | Application and behavioral scores; bureau data and platform behavior. | Built both scoring models and risk tiers for BNPL operations. | **Delinquency ~7% to <3%;** behavior-only models sustained roughly 3%. |
| Lending | **Small-business credit**<br>Hana Institute of Technology | Improve small-business risk differentiation. | ML application scoring with property, card, and other alternative data. | Developed scoring models and translated scores into credit grades. | **AUC improved from the 0.70s to the low 0.80s** against bureau benchmarks. |
| Fraud | **Payment FDS / KR / TW** | Protect payments while keeping manual review manageable. | Supervised / anomaly models; capacity simulations, reason codes, urgent queues. | Replaced rule-only routing with risk-ranked reviews and capacity-based thresholds. | **Review volume ~90% lower** in an overloaded queue; urgent cases prioritized. |
| Fraud | **Overseas-card acceptance** | Manage cold-start risk for overseas cards. | Country-level risk signals; surrogate models; chargeback monitoring. | Set initial thresholds and iterated with emerging fraud / chargeback data. | **Chargeback rate <0.3%** - less than one-tenth of the ~3% reference benchmark. |
| Fraud | **TW multi-account abuse** | Detect networks bypassing promotional purchase limits. | Neo4j and Louvain communities; daily to 6-hour / 3-hour monitoring. | Introduced graph detection; connected investigation workflows with account-policy discussions. | Observed multi-account coupon abuse was largely eliminated. |
| Fraud | **GenAI review assistance**<br>Ongoing / experimental | Reduce investigation effort while retaining novel-fraud sensitivity. | LLM review with graph context; guided and open-pattern review paths. | Designed review assistance and experiments on prompt anchoring and novel patterns. | *Review effort and novel-pattern recall under evaluation; ongoing iteration.* |
| Investing | **Robo-advisor**<br>Hana Institute of Technology | Launch an ML-driven investment product. | US ETF direction prediction and portfolio optimization. | Built prediction models; contributed to portfolio design and validation. | Passed the national robo-advisor testbed and reached product launch. |
| Marketing | **AutoML automation**<br>Hana Institute of Technology | Automate repeatable marketing analytics. | AutoML-based predictive modeling tools. | Contributed modeling and automation for marketing workflows. | Automated parts of the marketing analysis workflow. |

MCA: merchant cash advance / BNPL: buy now, pay later / FDS: fraud detection system / BA: business analyst. Rounded project observations; RAM increase is an estimate. The ~3% chargeback comparison is a project reference benchmark. Targets and experimental work are labeled.